J.P.Morgan

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China alt-data trackers chartpack (Series 59)

Limited government bond issuance pick-up so far

Emerging Markets Asia, Economic and Policy Research

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China's 2Q GDP fell well short of expectations, despite some upside surprise in June industrial production. This has prompted a reassessment of the 2H growth trajectory, with near-term momentum now in focus. We have updated our alt-data trackers (vs. our last update) and our key takeaways are below.

- **Exports**: Typhoon Bavi disrupted vessel traffic and port operations in the past week. Port tracking shows departing container (-15.4%) and bulk (-9.0%) shipping deadweight tonnage both declined in m/m nsa terms mtd in July.
- In aggregate, departing shipments' deadweight tonnage (excluding tankers) rose 8.7%oya mtd in July (vs. 17.2% in June), suggesting volume growth is moderating. But there could be some recovery as port operations normalize.
- Oil tanker arrivals decline narrowed to ~20 %oya mtd (vs. >30% in June).
- CCFI to USEC, USWC rose 8.6%, 14.9%, respectively, compared to two weeks ago; CCFI to the Persian Gulf/Red Sea route increased 6.6%.
- **Production**: Processed crude oil production contraction may have narrowed mtd in July (vs -17.7%oya in June), as petroleum asphalt plants' operating rates continued to recover in the first half of July. Auto production volume decline may have widened (vs -0.2% in June) while steel IP growth may have turned negative (vs 0.0% in June). Coke oven plants stabilized.
- **Fiscal**: Government bond issuance reached 1170bn yuan in July mtd, exceeding June's amount. But there will be over 450bn yuan of CGB maturities at month-end. With 2Q real GDP growth surprising to the downside, we expect faster fiscal deployment in 3Q to utilize the remaining approved annual quota.
- **Monetary**: PBOC net injected 1970bn yuan via pledged 7-day OMO in July mtd, while withdrawing 300bn yuan via outright OMO.
- 2Q MPC statement and PBOC press conference signaled no urgency for near-term easing and a gradual shift towards a price-based policy framework, prompting us to push our low-conviction rate cut call from 3Q to 4Q.
- **Auto sales** remained a drag on retail sales. Passenger car retail sales fell 15%oya in July 1-12, partially on lower per-car trade-in subsidies and purchase tax exemptions, and higher fuel costs. NEV sales fell a narrower 8%.
- **Housing**: Secondary home sales continued to outperform the same period last year, albeit at a slower pace, and new home sales contraction narrowed.
- **Inflation**: With a re-escalation of US-Iran tensions, Brent oil prices spiked in the past week. The transmission to domestic energy and petrochemical prices lagged. Agricultural food prices fell 2.3%oya in July mtd amid ample summer supply, widening the drag on headline CPI. Pork wholesale prices picked up in July mtd from the recent bottom, despite remaining in deflation.

See page 11 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

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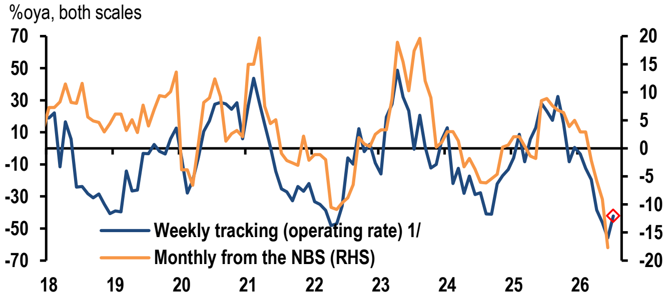
1. Mapping: High-frequency trackers --> official activity

Regarding the mapping efforts from high-frequency data to monthly official activity tracking:

- Operating rates for petroleum asphalt plants suggest **processed crude oil production** contraction may have narrowed mtd in July (vs -17.7%oya in June).
- Operating rates for tire plants suggest **auto production unit** decline may have widened mtd in July (vs -0.2%oya in June).
- Operating rates for steel rebar suggest that **steel IP** growth may have turned negative mtd in July (vs 0.0%oya in June).
- **Housing transactions** for 30 major cities fell 1.0%oya mtd in July (vs -7.3% in June).
- **Port tracking** suggests that export volume growth may have moderated mtd in July, as departing shipments deadweight tonnage (excluding tankers) rose 8.7%oya mtd in July (vs. 17.2% in June). This reflects shipping disruption caused by Typhoon Bavi, and port operation nomalization may bring some recovery in the second half of the month.

Figure 1.1: Industrial production - Processed crude oil

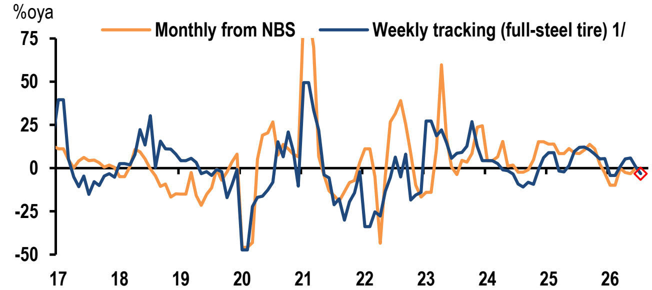
%oya, both scales



Source: CEIC, Wind, J.P. Morgan; 1/ Latest for July 2026.

Figure 1.2: Industrial production - Auto

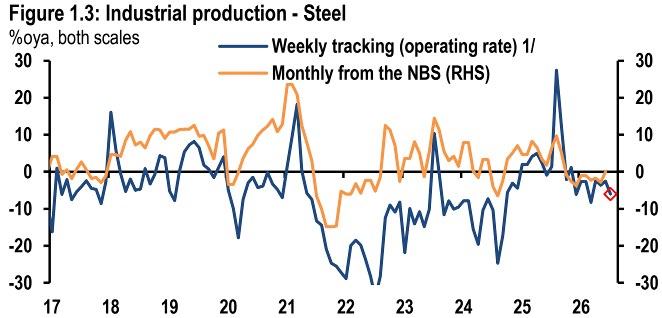
%oya



Source: CEIC, Wind, J.P. Morgan; 1/ Latest for July 2026.

Figure 1.3: Industrial production - Steel

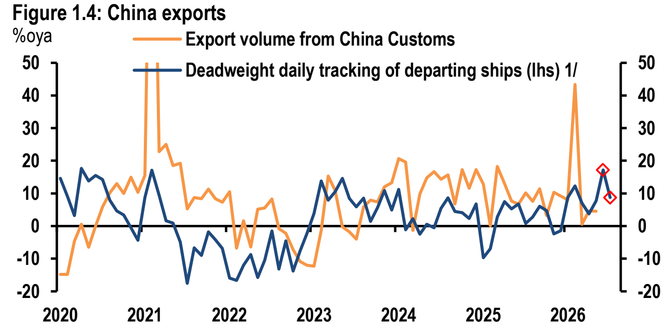
%oya, both scales



Source: CEIC, Wind, J.P. Morgan; 1/ Latest for July 2026.

Figure 1.4: China exports

%oya



Source: Elane Shipping, China Customs, J.P. Morgan; 1/ Latest for July 2026, excl. tankers

2. Trade

China's outbound container costs increased further across major routes, amid renewed Middle East tensions. By destination, CCFI to USEC, USWC rose 8.6%, 14.9%, respectively, compared to two weeks ago; CCFI to the Persian Gulf/Red Sea route increased by another 6.6%. Baltic Dry Index rebounded after a brief retreat. US-bound shipping dropped 13.5%oya or 21.0%m/m nsa mtd in July (vs 7.1%oya or 16.0%m/m nsa in June).

Typhoon Bavi disrupted vessel traffic and port operations at major East China ports during July 11-14.

- **Container ships** usually carry consumer goods, as well as some machinery equipment and electronics. Departing container ships' deadweight tonnage fell 11.6%oya or

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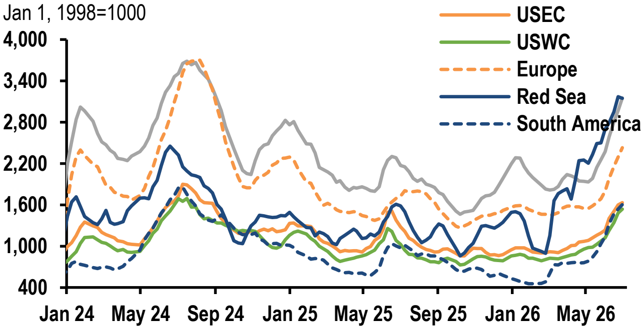
15.4%m/m nsa mtd in July. Arriving container ships' deadweight tonnage fell 13.9%oya or 15.8%m/m nsa.

- **Bulk carriers** transport unpackaged bulk cargo for grain, coal, iron ore, steel, etc., in their cargo holds. Departing bulk ships' deadweight tonnage rose 13.2%oya (or down 9.0%m/m nsa), while arriving bulk ships' deadweight tonnage rose 7.8%oya or down 12.3%m/m nsa.
- **Oil tanker** arrivals recovered somewhat, down ~20%oya mtd in July, compared to >30% contraction in June.

China's flight execution continued to recover, despite a mild uptick in the cancelation rate.

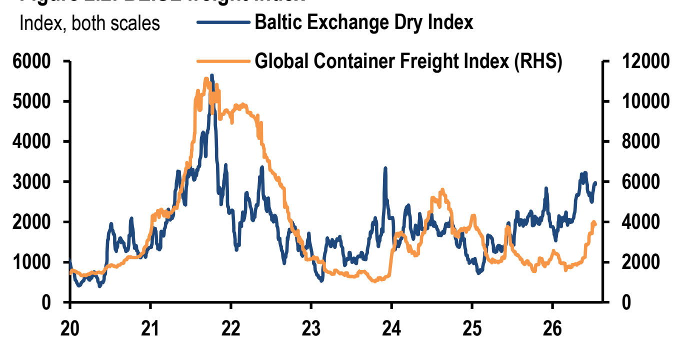
China's soybean imports from the world increased in June, exceeding previous years' levels. The White House statement said China would purchase at least US$17bn of US agricultural products annually from 2026 to 2028.

Figure 2.1: China containerized freight index
Jan 1, 1998=1000



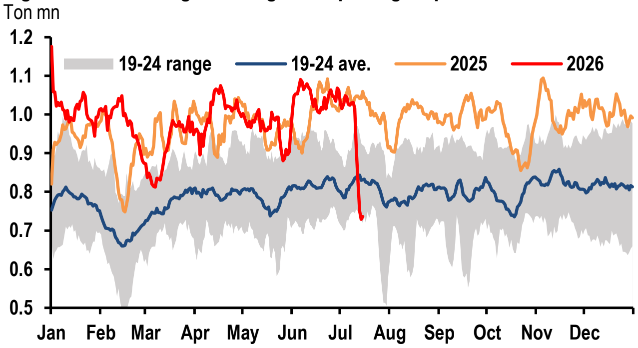
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 2.2: BEISL freight index
Index, both scales



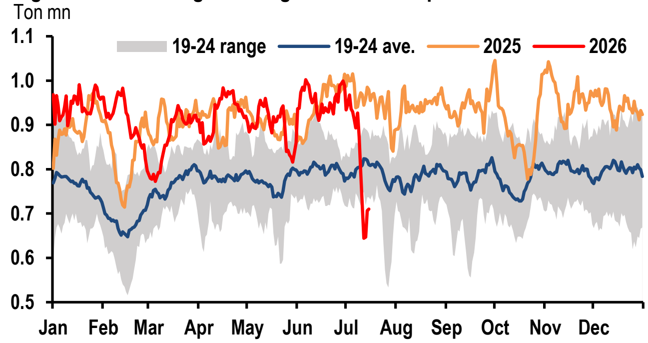
Source: Baltic Exchange Information Services Limited, J.P. Morgan

Figure 2.3: Deadweight tonnage of departing ships - Container
Ton mn



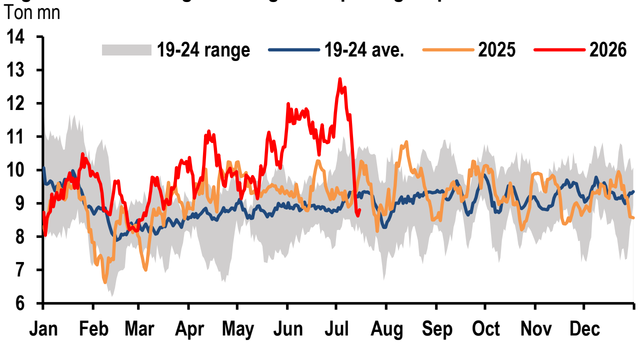
Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2.4: Deadweight tonnage of arrived ships - Container
Ton mn



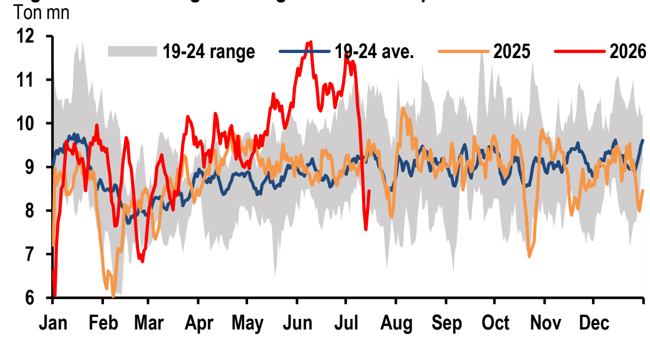
Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2.5: Deadweight tonnage of departing ships - Bulk
Ton mn



Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2.6: Deadweight tonnage of arrived ships - Bulk
Ton mn



Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

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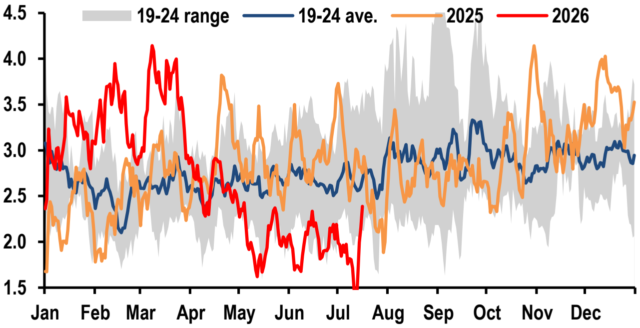
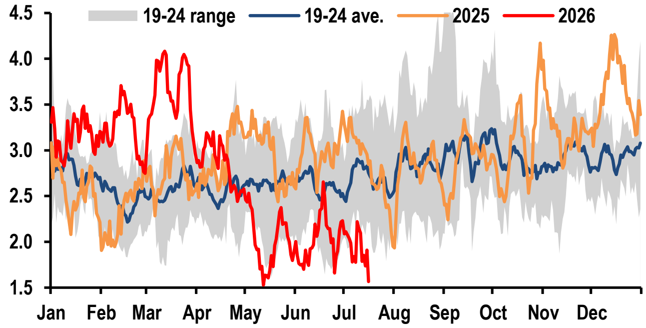
Figure 2.7: Deadweight tonnage of arrived ships - Oil Tanker
Ton mn



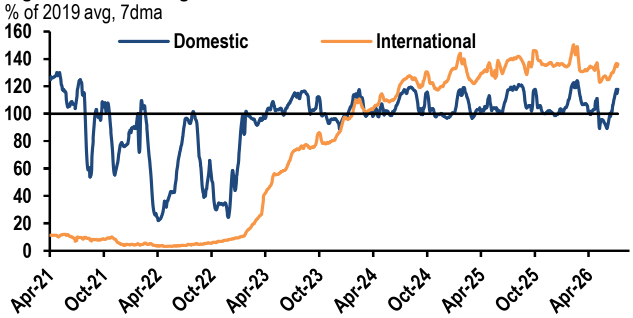
Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2.8: Deadweight tonnage of departing ships - Oil Tanker
Ton mn



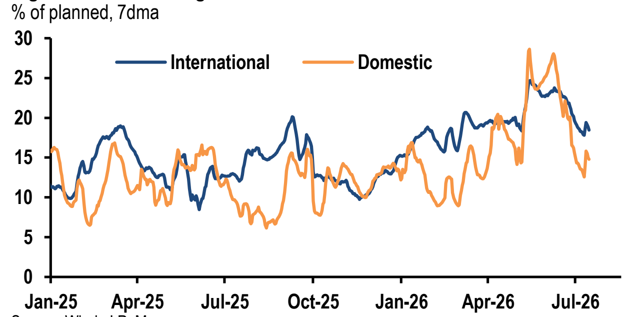
Source: Elane Shipping Statistics, J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2.9: China flight execution
% of 2019 avg, 7dma



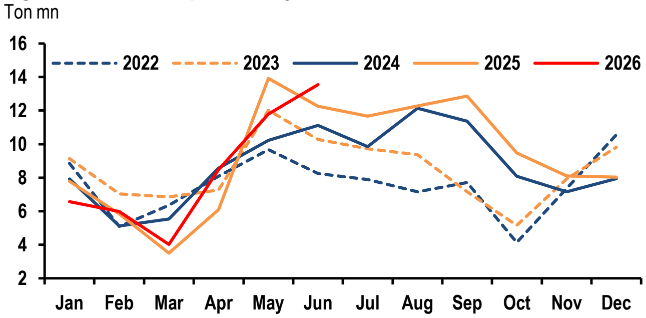
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 2.10: China flight cancellation rate
% of planned, 7dma



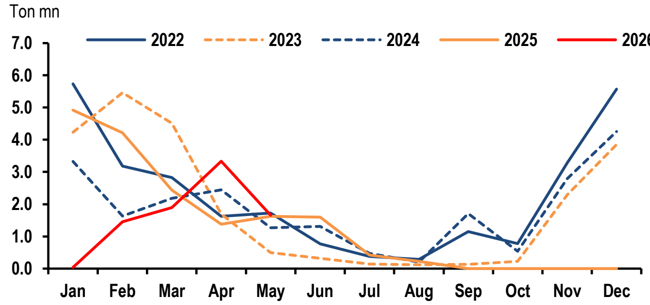
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 2.11: China imports of soybeans from world
Ton mn



Source: CEIC, J.P. Morgan

Figure 2.12: China imports of soybeans from US
Ton mn



Source: CEIC, J.P. Morgan

3. Sales and production

- **Auto sales:** According to CPCA, passenger car retail sales fell 15%oya in July 1-12, partially on lower per-car trade-in subsidies and purchase tax exemptions, and higher fuel costs. NEV sales fell a narrower 8%.
- **Operating rates** of petroleum asphalt plants continued to recover in the first half of July, though still lower than the pre-Middle East conflict levels. Operating rates for steel rebar ticked down mtd in July, while semi-steel tires continued to fall. Coke oven plants' operation rates stabilized after the modest fall from mid-May to early June.

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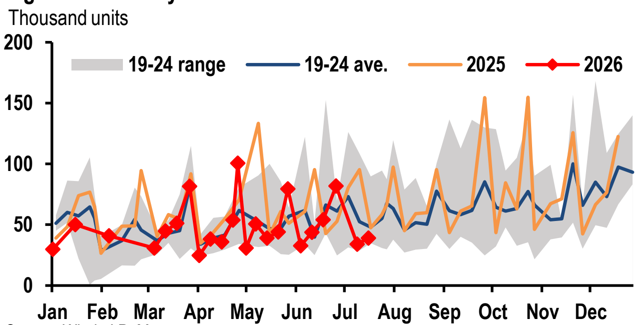
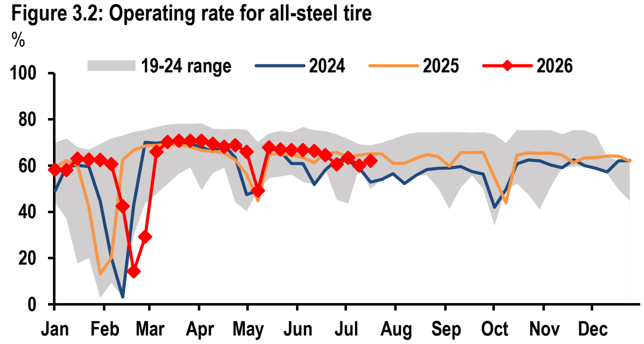
Figure 3.1: Weekly auto retail sales



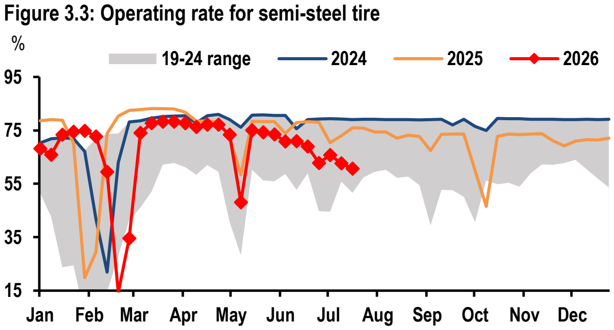
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3.2: Operating rate for all-steel tire



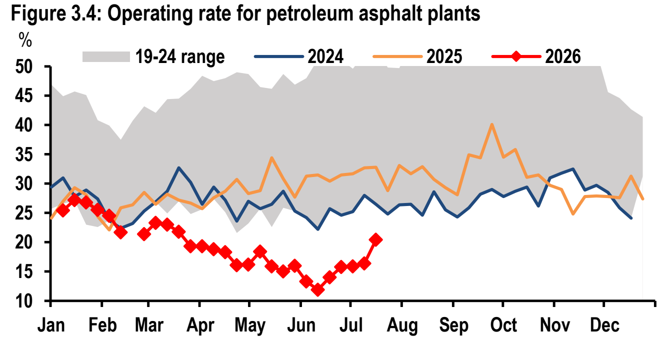
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3.3: Operating rate for semi-steel tire



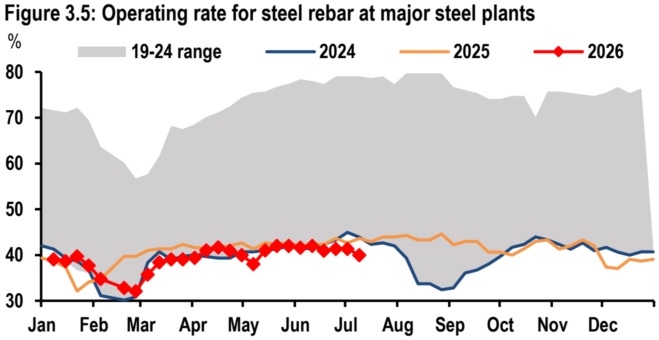
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3.4: Operating rate for petroleum asphalt plants



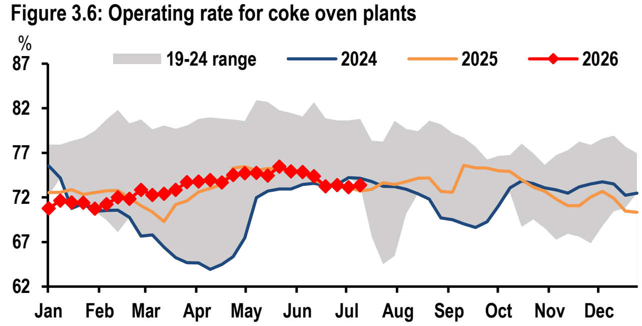
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3.5: Operating rate for steel rebar at major steel plants



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3.6: Operating rate for coke oven plants



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

4. Policy: Government bond issuance and liquidity operations

Government bond issuance reached 1170bn yuan in July mtd, exceeding June's amount. With 2Q real GDP growth surprising to the downside, we expect faster fiscal deployment in 3Q to utilize the remaining quota approved at March NPC.

- **CGB issuance** rose to 845bn yuan in July mtd (including scheduled issuance in the coming one week), compared to 318bn yuan in June. But there will be over 450bn yuan of CGB maturities at month-end, hence full-month net issuance will depend on the final week's issuance. Ytd issuance is reaching 52.9% of the annual issuance target, trailing last year's 57.4% pace. In terms of further breakdown, **special CGB issuance remained solid at 190bn yuan in July mtd (vs. 204bn yuan in June).**
- **Special LGB** issuance moderated to 222bn yuan in July mtd, after rising strongly to 572bn yuan in June. Year-to-date issuance reached 52.0% of the annual target, lagging last year's pace.
- **General LGB** issuance recorded 38bn yuan; **refinancing LGB** slowed to 65bn yuan (vs.

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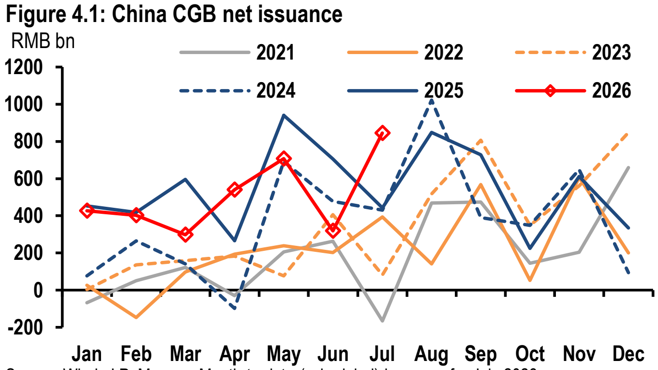
207bn yuan).

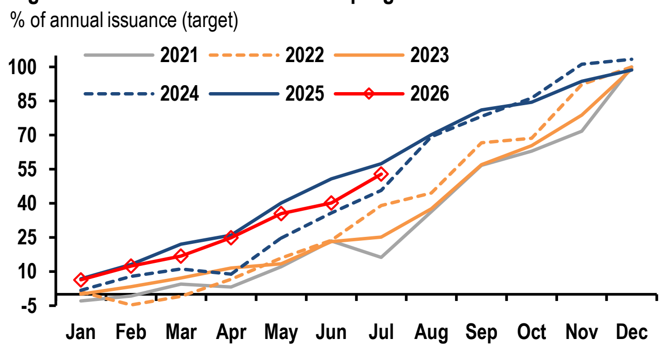
- PBOC net injected 1970bn yuan via pledged 7-day OMO in July mtd, while withdrawing 300bn yuan via outright OMO.
- 2Q MPC statement and PBOC press conference this week signaled no urgency for near-term easing and a gradual shift towards price-based monetary policy framework, prompting us to push our low-conviction rate cut call from 3Q to 4Q. As usual, a 10bp move would likely be more of a policy signal than a meaningful easing impulse.

Figure 4.1: China CGB net issuance



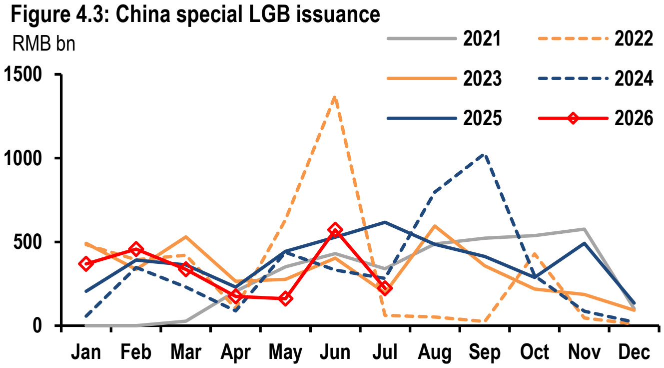
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.2: China CGB net issuance progress



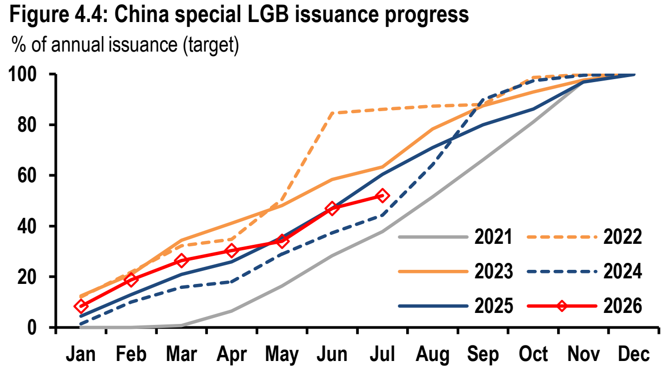
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.3: China special LGB issuance



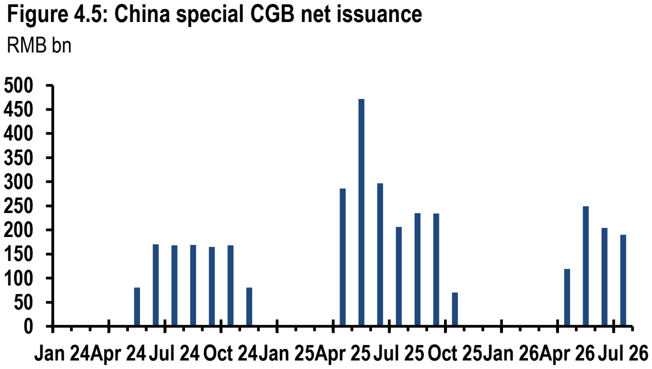
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.4: China special LGB issuance progress



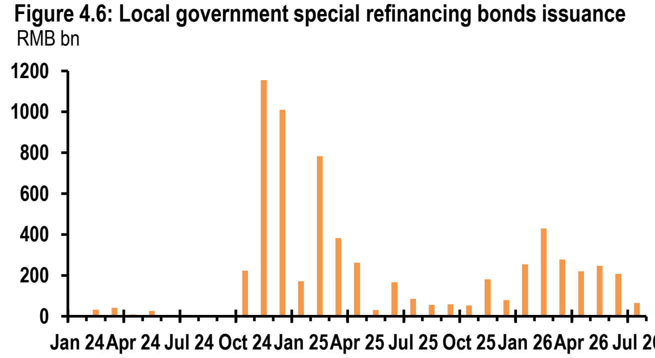
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.5: China special CGB net issuance



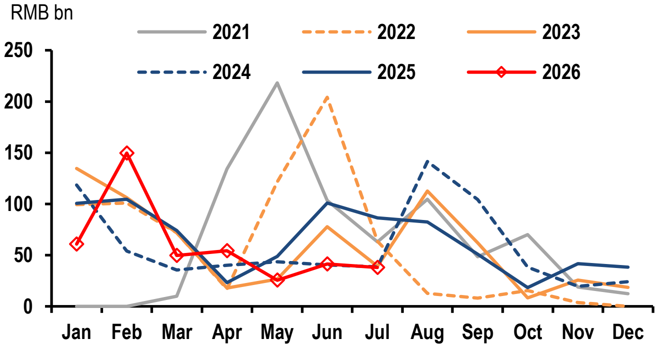
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan; Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.6: Local government special refinancing bonds issuance



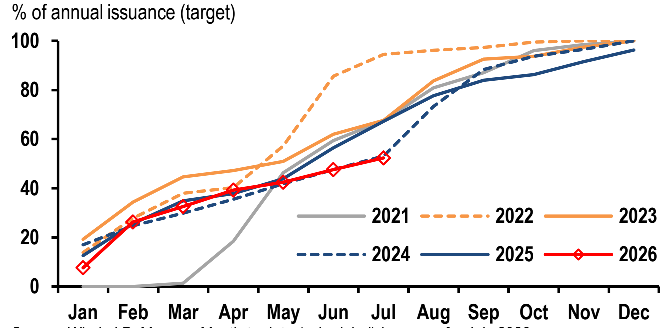
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan; Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.7: General LGB new issuance



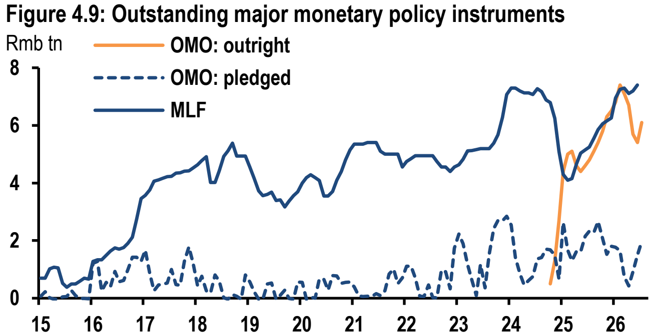
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.8: General LGB new issuance progress



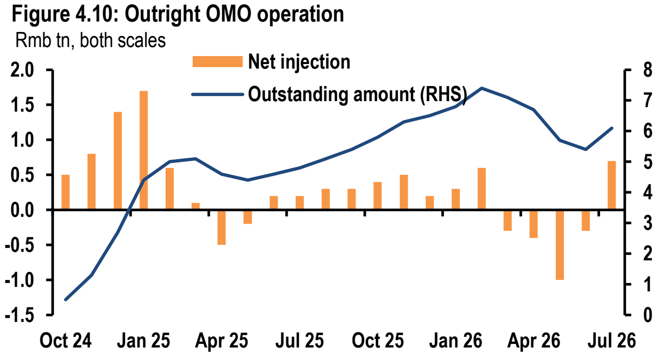
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Month-to-date (scheduled) issuance for July 2026.

Figure 4.9: Outstanding major monetary policy instruments



Source: PBOC, J.P. Morgan

Figure 4.10: Outright OMO operation



Source: PBOC, J.P. Morgan

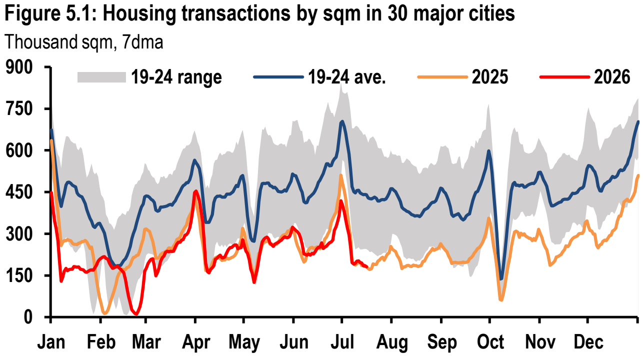
5. Housing

Secondary home sales continued to outperform the same period last year in July mtd, albeit at a slower pace, and new home sales %oya contraction narrowed.

- The contraction in 30 major cities' **new home sales narrowed** to -1.0%oya in July mtd from -7.3% in June, assuming the pace persists into month-end. Major cities' **secondary home sales** rose 3.5%oya in July mtd, despite moderating from 12.3%oya in June.
- Centaline's **sales manager confidence index** ticked up temporarily before easing back, while the secondary home asking price index edged down further.

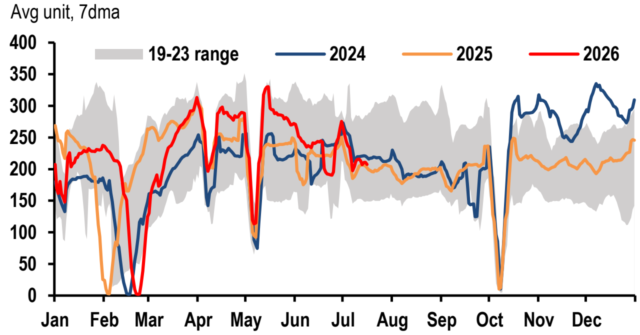
Land sales values fell in July mtd, continuing to weigh on government fund account revenues. The sales premium rate dropped at the beginning of July and was stable last week.

Figure 5.1: Housing transactions by sqm in 30 major cities



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 5.2: Major cities' secondary housing transactions

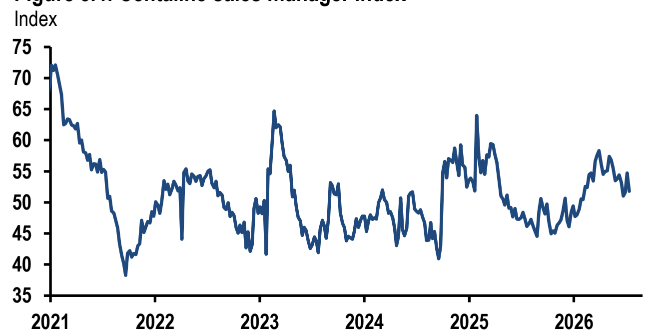


Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 5.3: Centaline tier-1 cities' secondary asking price index

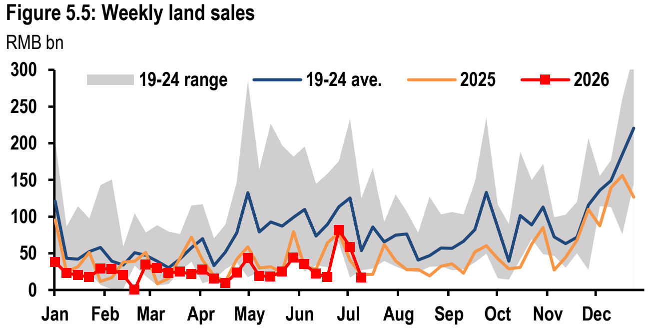
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Note: Simple average for 4 tier-1 cities.

Figure 5.4: Centaline sales manager index



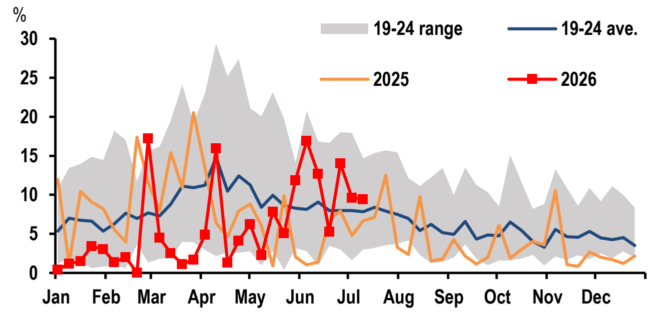
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan. Note: Simple average for Shanghai, Shenzhen and Guangzhou.

Figure 5.5: Weekly land sales



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 5.6: Land sale premium rate



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

6. Inflation

- **With the re-escalation of US-Iran tensions, Brent oil prices spiked in the recent week. The transmission to domestic energy prices lagged, with gasoline, diesel, LNG and LPG prices continuing to moderate in the first ten days of July.** Coal prices have also started to ease, despite summer seasonal demand.
- **Most petrochemical products prices fell further in the first ten days of July, while sulfuric acid prices continued to rise.** Prices of polyethylene, polypropylene, and rubber have declined to near pre-conflict levels. Polyester yarn and methanol prices have also eased, though they remain above pre-conflict levels. Petro-benzene prices ticked up lately.
- **Compared to the same period last year, agricultural food price fell 2.3%oya in July mtd amid ample summer supply** (vs -0.5% in June), widening the drag on headline CPI. Rice, wheat and corn prices were largely stable.
- **Pork wholesale prices picked up in July mtd from the recent trough, with price deflation narrowing to -25.1%oya (vs. -28.3%oya in June)**, as overcapacity and profitability pressure in the industry accelerated the destocking process.
- **Lithium** carbonate prices edged lower in July mtd, while **polysilicon** prices were largely unchanged at a subdued level relative to early 2026.
- Copper prices picked up in July mtd, remaining elevated on AI-related demand, while aluminum prices rebounded over the past two weeks. Cement and steel rebar prices both ticked down.

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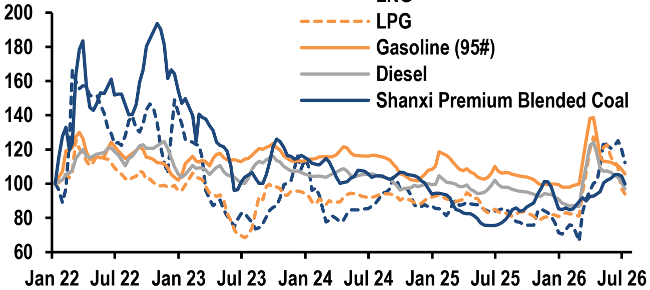
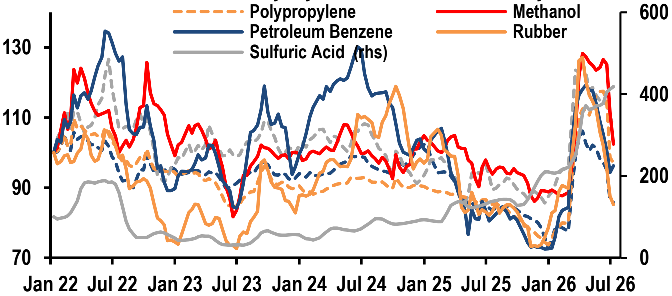
Figure 6.1: Energy price
Jan 2022 = 100



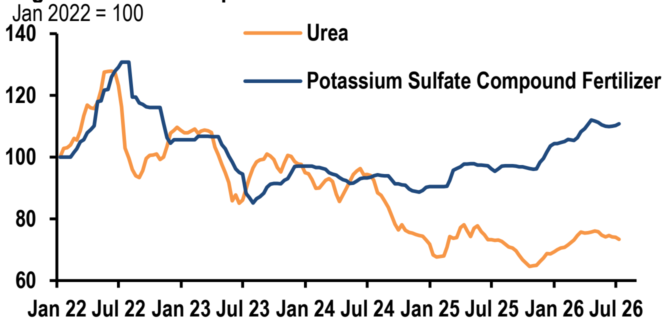
Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.2: Petrochemical product price
Jan 2022 = 100



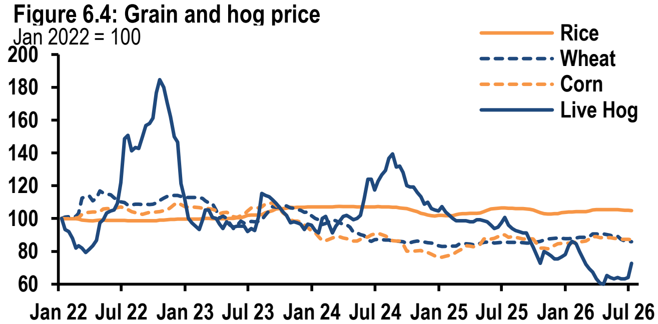
Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.3: Fertilizer price
Jan 2022 = 100



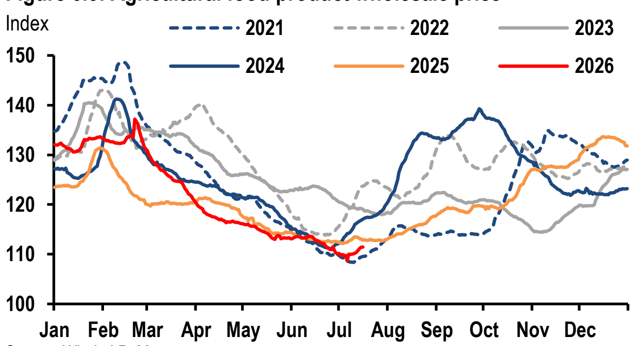
Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.4: Grain and hog price
Jan 2022 = 100



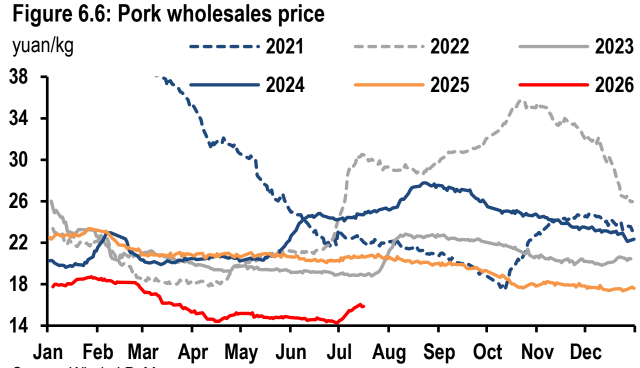
Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.5: Agricultural food product wholesale price
Index



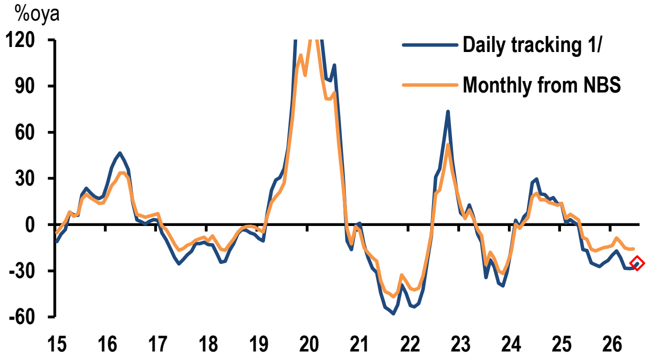
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.6: Pork wholesales price
yuan/kg



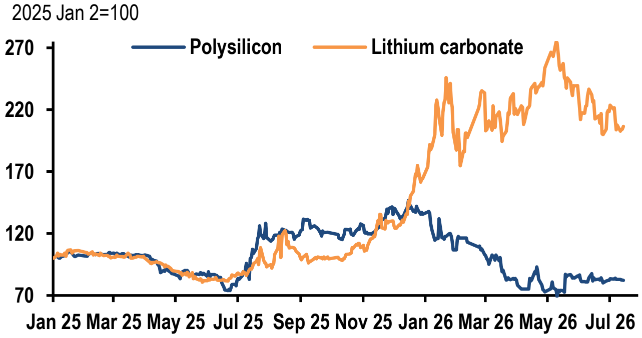
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.7: Pork wholesales price vs. NBS data
%oya



Source: NBS, Wind, J.P. Morgan. 1/ Latest for May 2026.

Figure 6.8: Commodity futures prices
2025 Jan 2=100



Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

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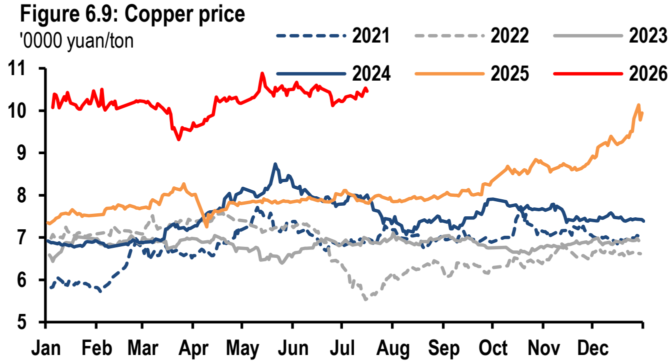
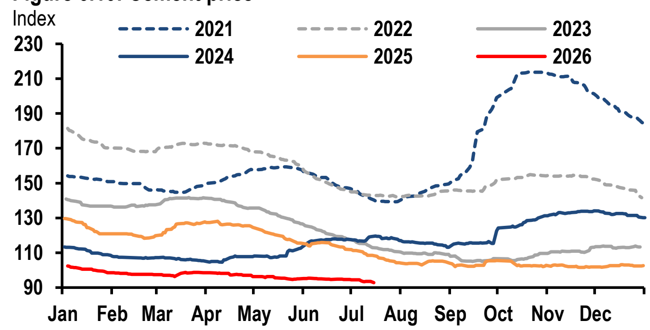
Figure 6.9: Copper price



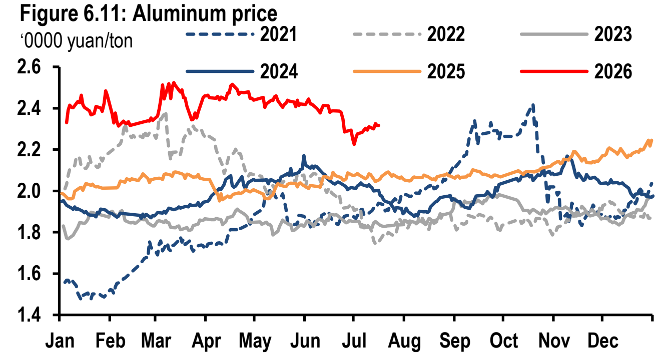
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.10: Cement price



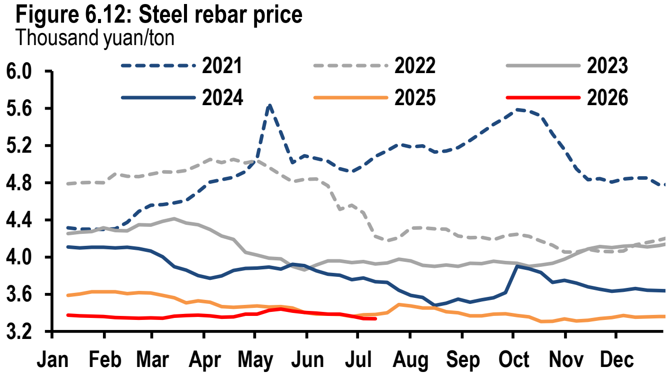
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.11: Aluminum price



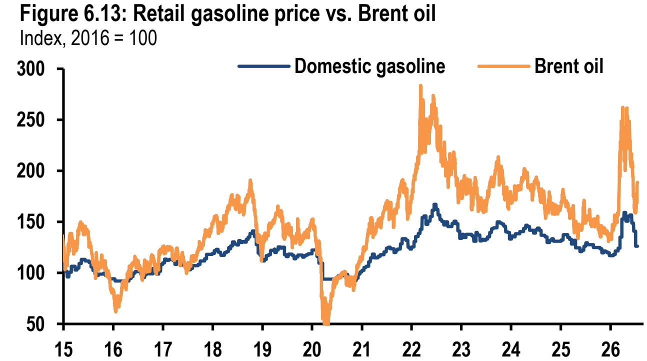
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.12: Steel rebar price



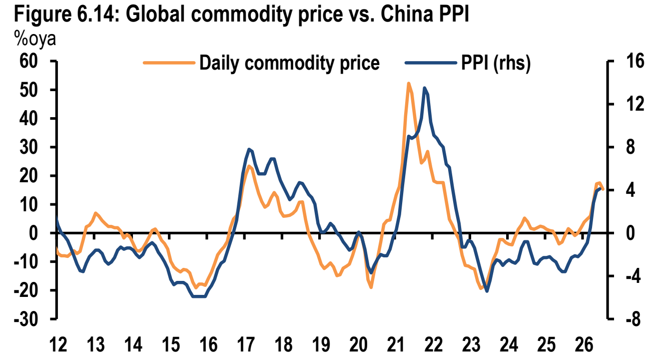
Source: Wind, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.13: Retail gasoline price vs. Brent oil



Source: CEIC, J.P. Morgan

Figure 6.14: Global commodity price vs. China PPI



Source: Haver, J.P. Morgan

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